Table 2.1 Four Food Groups		
S.No.	**Food Groups**	**Main Nutrients**
1	**Cereals, millets and pulses:** Rice, wheat, bajra, maize, ragi, jowar, barley, rice flakes, wheat flour, malted cereals, Bengal gram, black gram, green gram, red gram (whole as well as dhals) cow pea, peas, rajmah, soya bean, beans, horse gram and sprouted pulses	Energy, protein, invisible fat, thiamine, riboflavin, folic acid, iron, calcium and fibre
2	**Vegetables and Fruits** **Green leafy vegetables:** Amaranth, spinach, drumstick leaves, beetroot leaves, coriander leaves, curry leaves, mustard leaves, fenugreek leaves	Carotenoids, riboflavin, folic acid, calcium, iron, fibre
	Other vegetables: Carrot, onion, brinjal, ladies finger, capsicum, beans, drumstick, cauliflower	Carotenoids, folic acid, calcium, fibre
	Fruits: Guava, tomato, mango ripe, papaya, orange, sweet lime, water melon, grapes, amla	Carotenoids, vitamin-C, fibre
3	**Milk and milk products, egg, meat and fish** **Milk and Milk Products:** Milk, curd, skimmed milk, cheese	Protein, fat, riboflavin, calcium,
	Egg	High biological value protein, vitamin A
	Meat: Chicken, liver, mutton	Protein, fat, vitamin-A, cyanocobalamin
	Fish	Omega3 Fatty acid, Vitamin A & E
4	**Oils & fats and nuts & oilseeds:** Butter, ghee, hydrogenated fat (vanaspathy), gingelly oil, groundnut oil, mustard oil, coconut oil Ground nuts, Gingelly seeds, Cashew nuts, Almonds	Energy fat, essential fatty acids, fat soluble vitamins

Source: Nutritive Value of Indian Foods, National Institute of Nutrition, ICMR (2017)

tool for planning a health promoting diet. The food pyramid (Figure 2.2) provides recommendation for the number of daily servings that should be consumed from each of the food groups. Food pyramid clearly represents that cereals should form the major bulk of the diet followed by fruits and vegetables, pulses, milk and meat products and less amount of sugar and oils. Food pyramid helps an

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